Broken at the Well

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Manuscript excerpt

BROKEN AT THE WELL — When Jesus Ends a Generational Rebellion

1) JESUS MUST GO BY SAMARIA — SCRIPTURE

Let’s begin in John 4:3–4:

“He left Judaea and departed again into Galilee. And He MUST needs go through Samaria.”

Now, to us, that may sound like a simple travel route — a GPS note.
But to the Jewish mind, this was shocking.
Jews avoided Samaria at all costs.
Geographically, there were two easier, cleaner routes:

The Jordan Valley Route — longer, but safe and acceptable.

The King’s Highway Route — used by rabbis who refused even to touch Samarian soil.

But John says Jesus must go through Samaria.
Not “should,” not “might,” not “it happened that way.”

Must.

That word signals divine necessity — a heaven-level appointment.
A spiritual collision course.
A moment written into eternity long before Jacob ever dug that well.

Why must He go?

Because there is a woman who has lost her identity.
Because there is a region shaped by centuries of rebellion.
Because there is a well stained with history and heartache.
Because there is a conversation waiting that will alter the destiny of a city.
Because God is about to undo what kings destroyed.

Jesus didn’t go around their pain —
He walked straight into it.

And that’s why this story matters today.
Because the Jesus who “must needs go through Samaria”
still must go through your Samaria —
the places you avoid, the wounds you hide, the history you inherited.

"The Appointment Was Bigger Than One Woman"

We often preach that Jesus went because one woman needed saving. And that's true. But I believe there was something even greater happening.

Jesus wasn't only walking toward one broken life...

He was walking toward five hundred years of broken history.

Heaven had an appointment with Samaria.

The woman was the doorway.

The city was the objective.

The generations were the harvest.

“If Jesus had to go through Samaria, then we must understand what Samaria was. And for that, we turn to the history Josephus preserved.”

2) BRIEF HISTORY FROM JOSEPHUS ON SAMARIA

To understand Samaria, you must see the centuries beneath its soil.

Josephus — the great Jewish historian — tells us that Samaria was not an ordinary city.
It was the capital of rebellion.

A. It began with Jeroboam

Jeroboam broke away from Jerusalem, built his own kingdom, and intentionally created an alternative religion:

Golden calves at Dan and Bethel

New priests not from the tribe of Levi

A counterfeit altar

A forbidden feast day

A worship system designed to keep people away from the true presence of God

Josephus emphasizes that this move wasn’t political — it was spiritual sabotage.
Jeroboam feared losing control, so he built a religion that kept God at a distance.

B. Samaria was built by Omri

Josephus writes that Omri purchased a hill and built a city “strongly fortified and beautiful,” calling it Samaria.

It became:

The royal palace

The political headquarters

The spiritual center of the northern rebellion

It was a city built without God.

C. Ahab enlarged the rebellion

Josephus says Ahab:

Introduced Phoenician worship

Married Jezebel

Built a Baal temple

Filled the land with false prophets

Persecuted the prophets of God

Josephus records that wickedness in Ahab's day reached a level never seen before.

D. Assyrian destruction & resettlement

Josephus details how:

Samaria was conquered

Its people deported

Foreign nations brought in

Intermarriage was forced

New religions were blended

Priests were imported to teach a confused version of Mosaic law

This created a people:

Mixed in blood

Mixed in belief

Mixed in identity

This is why Jews despised Samaritans — not simply because they were "different," but because they represented centuries of rebellion and compromise.

"So now we understand the rebellious soil… but let's meet the kings who sowed the seeds."

3) INTRODUCTION TO THE KINGS BEGINNING WITH JEROBOAM —

It's what happens when one leader's fear-driven compromise becomes the inheritance of generations.